Electronics Return Policy

ShopSphere Retail - serial-tracked electronics (audio, laptops, wearables, small devices)

Policy ID	POL-ELEC-2024-03
Version	3.2
Effective date	2025-01-01
Applicable category	electronics
Return window (days)	30
Policy owner	Returns Policy Office, Mumbai
Review cycle	Annual, or earlier on regulatory change

1. Purpose and scope

This policy defines when electronics purchased on ShopSphere may be returned, what evidence is required, and how refunds are approved. It applies to every product whose catalogue category is electronics, including SoundPeak audio products and TechNova laptops. Serial-tracked products are subject to the additional identity checks in section 4.

2. Return window

The standard electronics return window is 30 days from delivery. The delivery date is the date recorded in the ShopSphere delivery system (deliveries.delivery_date); day 0 is the day of delivery. A return request raised on or before day 30 is within the window. A request raised after day 30 is outside the return window and cannot be approved under this policy; it is routed to policy exception review, and where the product is still covered by its manufacturer warranty the customer is offered the warranty route instead.

Situation	Window	Route
Change of mind (unused, complete, original packaging)	30 days from delivery	Standard return
Not functioning / defective	30 days from delivery	Return with inspection; warranty afterwards
Damaged on arrival	Report within 48 hours (see POL-DMG-2024-04)	Damage claim
Wrong product delivered	30 days from delivery	Manual investigation of SKU/serial
Request after the window	-	Policy exception review or warranty claim

3. Eligibility

- Change of mind: the product must be unused, factory reset, free of personal accounts, and returned with all accessories and original packaging.
- Defect or not functioning: the fault must be verified by a warehouse inspection before a refund is approved. An inspection that cannot reproduce the fault is recorded as inconclusive and escalated.
- Missing accessories: a return with incomplete accessories is not eligible for a full refund without policy exception review.
- Wrong product: the returned item is checked against the order line SKU and, where applicable, the purchased serial number.

4. Serial-tracked products

For serial-tracked products the serial number dispatched is stored on the order line (order_items.purchased_serial_number). The receiving warehouse records the serial of the unit actually returned (inspections.returned_serial_number). If the two differ, the return is placed on hold, an investigation

case of type serial_mismatch is opened, and no refund may be requested until the mismatch is resolved. Investigation notes must describe evidence, not customer intent. Where records disagree (for example serial numbers or SKUs), the outcome is recorded as "additional verification required" and the case is routed for manual review.

5. Exceptions and non-returnable items

- Software licences or digital codes that have been activated.
- Products with a removed, altered or illegible serial label (handled as additional verification required).
- Products with liquid exposure indicators triggered, unless the damage is reported as delivery damage under POL-DMG-2024-04.
- Policy exceptions outside the window may be approved only by a returns supervisor, with the reason recorded on the investigation case.

6. Required documentation

- Order ID and return ID.
- Purchased serial number (from the invoice or order line) and photograph of the serial label on the returned unit.
- Description of the fault and, for defects, the steps to reproduce.
- Confirmation that personal data has been erased (laptops and smart devices).

7. Refund approval thresholds

Refund amount	Approver	Notes
Up to INR 10,000	Returns analyst	Every refund raised by the returns investigation assistant needs a human approval before execution.
INR 10,000.01 to INR 50,000	Returns supervisor	Analyst recommendation plus supervisor sign-off.
Above INR 50,000	Returns supervisor and Finance controller	Dual approval; inspection report must be attached.
Any amount with an open investigation case	Returns supervisor	Refund is held until the case is resolved.

8. Refund rules

- A return may have at most one completed refund. Before any refund is requested, the refunds ledger must be checked; if a completed refund already exists for the return_id, no further refund may be requested or executed.
- Refunds are issued to the original payment method within 5-7 business days of approval. Store credit is issued only when the customer selects it.
- Refund amounts may not exceed the unit price paid on the order line (order_items.unit_price), excluding any promotional cashback already reversed.

9. Related documents

- POL-DMG-2024-04 Damaged Products and Damaged-in-Transit Policy
- WTY-ELEC-2025-01 Electronics Category Warranty Terms
- RFB-GEN-2025-01 Returned Goods Recovery and Disposition Framework